



Merchant Marine **Notice**

Panama Maritime Authority
General Directorate of Merchant Marine
Control and Compliance Department

F-34
(DCCM)
V.04

REMINDER ON MANDATORY COMPLIANCE AND FLAG STATE REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

No: **MMN-08/2026**

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1. The purpose of this Marine Notice is to remind Masters of Panama flagged vessels of their obligations regarding the timely notification to the Administration of any accident, defect, or deficiency affecting the vessel's condition after statutory surveys.
 2. All Masters are reminded of their statutory obligations concerning the continuous maintenance of vessel's conditions and the mandatory reporting of defects in accordance with Regulation 11 of Chapter I of the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), as amended.
 3. Maintaining the operational integrity and seaworthiness of vessels registered under Panamanian flag is not only a fundamental safety priority but also a legal requirement under applicable international conventions.
 4. Therefore, the Master shall ensure that both the bridge and engine departments are fully aware of and comply with the following requirements:
 5. **Maintenance After Survey - SOLAS Chapter I, Regulation 11 a) and b).**
 - 5.1. **Operational Readiness:** The vessel, its machinery, equipment and arrangements shall be properly maintained to ensure that the ship remains fit to proceed to sea without danger to the ship, personnel on board, or the marine environment.
 - 5.2. **Unauthorized Changes:** No structural, machinery, equipment or fittings covered by statutory surveys shall be carried out after completion of the survey without prior authorization from the **Administration or the duly authorized Recognized Organization acting on behalf of the Administration.**

6. Incident and Defect Reporting - SOLAS Chapter I, Regulation 11 c).

6.1. In the event that any accident occurs to the vessel or any defect is discovered that affects the safety of the ship or the efficiency or completeness of its life-saving or fire-fighting equipment, the following actions shall be taken:

6.1.1. Immediate Notification: The Master must report the issue at the earliest opportunity to the Flag Administration and the vessel's Recognized Organization (Classification Society).

6.1.2. Port State Coordination: When the vessel is in a foreign port, the Master must also notify the defect immediately to the local Port State Authority.

7. Deficiency Rectification Timeline.

7.1. Standard Window period: Any deficiency or minor non-conformity identified on board must be effectively rectified within a maximum period of three (3) months unless otherwise instructed by the Administration or the Recognized Organization.

7.2. Accelerated Requirements: Where a shorter rectification period is required by the Administration or a Port State Control Authority (PSC), such instruction shall prevail and must be strictly complied with.

8. Mandatory Panama Pre-Arrival Checklist (MMC-404).

8.1. All vessel's Masters and their Designated Persons Ashore (DPA) are reminded that submission of the Pre-arrival checklist is compulsory for all Panamanian-registered vessels calling at ports within the jurisdiction of the United States Coast Guard (USCG), Paris Memorandum of Understanding (Paris MoU), Australian Maritime Safety Authority (AMSA), and China Maritime Safety Administration (China MSA).

8.2. To ensure compliance with MMC-404, the checklist must be dully completed, signed by the Master and submitted via email to prearrival@amp.gob.pa at least **120 hours** prior arrival, or **24 hours** prior for voyages lasting less than 96 hours.

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8.3. Any equipment malfunction, operational limitation, or extraordinary circumstance affecting the vessel's compliance must be reported immediately to both the Recognized Organization (RO) and Segumar Offices in order to coordinate the appropriate corrective actions plan.

9. Failure to report

9.1. Failure to submit the mandatory pre-arrival check list constitute a serious breach of the Administration's reporting requirements and may result in administrative sanctions.

9.2. Failure to report a known defect or deficiency to this Administration and the relevant Port State Authority prior to an inspection may lead to detention of the vessel and potential legal or administrative consequences.

March, 2026 – New.

Inquiries concerning the subject of this Merchant Marine Notice or any other request should be forward to:

Navigation and Maritime Safety Department
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Panama Maritime Authority

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Website: <https://panamashipregistry.com/marine-category/marine-notices/>